Fund evidence, then a pilot

Real process friction. Conditional value. A gated investment decision.

Decision requested

Authorize a 30-day discovery stage within a **$12,000 build envelope**. Release controlled-pilot funding only after offline safety and value gates pass. **Do not approve deployment of the current lexical router.**

Observed problem: real process evidence

7,554 public incidents contain **9,454 team changes** (1.25 per case). 15.6% of cases include an A-B-A bounce. Mean pre-transfer elapsed time is 64.9 hours; this includes waiting and work and is **not measured labor or avoidable waste**.

Conditional business case: illustrative USD assumptions

Input / output	Base case
Annual volume / effort / loaded rate	20,000 tickets / 10 active min per handoff / $45 per hour
Intervention / review assumptions	25% fewer handoffs / 20% reviewed at 5 min each
Modeled current annual handoff labor cost	$187,728
Net annual labor capacity released	710 hours, after review effort
Build / annual run / year-one TCO	$12,000 / $6,600 / $18,600
Annual net value / year-one net value	$25,332 / $13,332
Simple payback after go-live	5.7 months

TCO: build = 160 hours x $75; run = $150 platform + $100 model usage + $300 operations per month. These are budget assumptions, not supplier quotes. No resolver-fix savings, delay monetization or discounting included. Capacity is not cash unless Finance validates realization.

Evidence and stop gates

Current synthetic lexical test: 10% first-time-right versus 90% keyword baseline; 90% review rate. This fails the +10-point gain and <=40% review gates. A future pilot also requires <=5% wrong auto-assignments, verified fix usefulness, adoption and positive net value. No AI benefit is proven on the public process log.

Source: Ward Steeman (2013), BPI Challenge 2013 incidents, 4TU.ResearchData. Dataset DOI. Historical public log; not a statement of current Volvo operations.